

points in a presentation limited to six or so. That could be seven, and eight would just about stretch it. But here's something new: ideally one slide, and no more than two, per key point. It would take a Ph.D. in Presentation Science to tell us why Man absorbs more this way, but when you advance a slide, the audience would like to see a new topic. That's the way it is.

Tip

An audience hates to see a mixture of *incompatible* fonts. This is an idea we can't speak much about here, but imagine a presentation with Times New Roman and Lucida handwriting (look at the latter in Word or PowerPoint) on the same slide. They just don't gel, and you won't sell!

Fonts are important

Few things are as underestimated in terms of power as the Font—be it in journals, flyers, or presentations. (Books and magazines do tend to choose fonts with great care, and with good reason.) A good volume could be written on this, but to cut a good volume short, fonts have tremendous psychological impact—an impact on the way information is perceived and absorbed.

It's one of those thankless situations: use the right font and no-one notices; use the wrong one and everybody curses you.

Even as a movie-maker is afraid of going to extremes because the movie is made for a wide audience, so you should be afraid of using "extreme" fonts because you're going to present in front of several kinds of people.

The safe fonts are the usual suspects: Verdana, Calibri, Arial, Lucida Sans. If you don't know all these, take a look and gauge for yourself.

Extreme fonts would be Impact, Broadway, Goudy Stout, Haettenschweiler, variants of Copperplate, and such. Again, take a look. If they aren't on your system, look on the Internet to see what we mean.